

Pre-specified rescue arm as a cross-over test.

Standard-of-care non-responders were switched to eCTM at Week 12 and followed to Week 26.

Background

OBJECTIVE

Randomized trials of rescue therapy typically cannot answer whether the rescue drug actually works, because rescued animals are a self-selected non-responder cohort. This trial pre-specified a rescue arm at Week 12 with cross-over to equicenta® CTM (eCTM), creating an embedded cross-over test on the poorest-responding cases.

Methods

RESCUE CRITERION AND ELIGIBILITY

146 client-owned performance horses with a suspensory-ligament or tendon injury were enrolled and 1:1 randomized to eCTM or clinician-selected standard of care at Week 0. A blinded veterinary panel identified non-responders at Week 12. 19 horses (13%) met the pre-specified rescue criterion between Weeks 12 and 26.

CROSS-OVER ARMS

Standard of care to eCTM (n=10): switched to eCTM (11 injections). Repeat eCTM (n=7): received a second eCTM injection (9 injections). Standard of care to standard of care (n=2): switched to a different standard-of-care modality. Rescue rate did not differ between primary treatment arms (p>0.09).

STATISTICAL PLAN

Week-26 return-to-work outcomes were compared across rescue arms using ANOVA with post-hoc contrasts, in both ITT and per-protocol populations (both p<0.001).

Interpretation

STANDARD-OF-CARE NON-RESPONDERS RECOVER ON eCTM

Because rescue-eligible horses are, by construction, the primary study's non-responders, their Week-26 convergence with primary-eCTM performance is a stringent test of drug effect. The trial's rescue arm functions as an embedded cross-over: standard-of-care failures who switched to eCTM reached the same performance ceiling as horses who received eCTM first (p=0.87), while the small standard of care on standard of care group declined significantly (p<0.001).

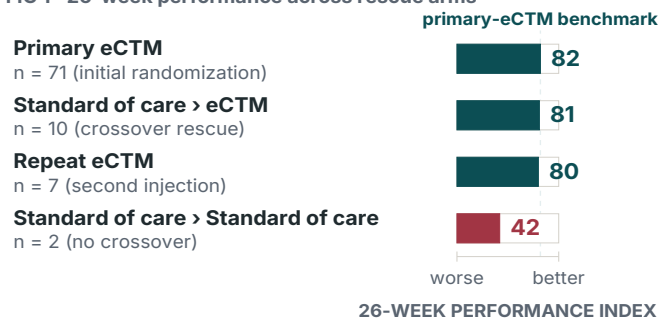
Results

CROSSOVERS FROM STANDARD OF CARE VS PRIMARY eCTM (WK 26)

p = 0.87

Crossovers were indistinguishable from primary-eCTM at Week 26. Repeat-eCTM also matched. Standard of care on standard of care declined (p<0.001).

FIG 1 · 26-week performance across rescue arms



Higher scores indicate better return-to-work performance. Three eCTM arms converge on the primary-eCTM benchmark (dashed line); standard of care on standard of care diverges downward.

Salvage that works — within the same trial.

The pre-specified cross-over rescued the study's own non-responders and closed the efficacy gap with primary-eCTM horses.

Equine Performance Labs